



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships (FT26)

UQ Research Office – Guide to building your Application

Version 1

September 2025

Guide Overview

- This document has been prepared by the Research Office to assist applicants in the development of their ARC Future Fellowships (FT) application for funding commencing in 2026.
- The guide provides advice on suggested approaches to key sections of the application form and is supported with examples from past successful UQ applications.
- The guide is intended to be used in conjunction with additional UQ resources available from the Research Office ARC Future Fellowships [web page](#), including UQ's templates, Information Session slides/recording, key findings and library resources.
- Applicants should fully familiarise themselves with the ARC documentation, including the ARC Discovery Program Grant Guidelines and Instructions to Applicants available from [GrantConnect](#).

FT26 Scheme Overview

The [ARC Future Fellowships grant opportunity](#) seeks to retain and attract the best and brightest mid-career researchers to undertake high-quality research programs in areas of national and international benefit.

The scheme provides four-year fellowships, and up to \$60,000 in additional non-salary funding per annum, to enhance the scale and focus of Australian research, and promote collaboration across industry, research institutions and other disciplines.

Assessment Criteria for Future Fellowship applications	Weighting
Investigator/Capability	50%
Project Quality and Innovation	25%
Benefit	15%
Feasibility	10%

Future Fellowship Scheme – UQ Disclosure of Interests

UQ upholds a strong position that we are stewards of public money and public trust and that we undertake research in the national interest.

UQ requires its staff to register interests via four registers:

- [Conflict of Interest \(Disclosure and Management of Interests Register\)](#)
- [Secondary Employment Register](#)
- [Sensitive Research Register](#)
- [Foreign Influence](#)

All UQ staff are required to complete the registers even if you have nothing to disclose.

To complete your disclosures:

1. Go to your [UQ dashboard](#)
2. Click on My Requests
3. Click on New Request
4. Select the register you need from the list and complete.

This should be done annually and whenever there is a change to circumstances.

ARC – Preprints or comparable resources

Preprints or comparable resources can be included in any part of an application.

Definition: *A preprint or comparable resource is a scholarly output that is uploaded by the authors to a recognised publicly accessible archive, repository, or preprint service (such as, but not limited to, arXiv, bioRxiv, medRxiv, ChemRxiv, Peer J Preprints, Zenodo, GitHub, PsyArXiv and publicly available university or government repositories etc.). They may have been subjected to varying degrees of peer review from none to light and full review.*

- **Identifying preprints:** Any citation of a preprint or comparable resource should be explicitly identified by including “[PREPRINT OR COMPARABLE]” at the end of the reference and listed with a DOI, URL or equivalent, version number and/or date of access, as applicable.
- Preprints listed in the ROPE Research Outputs list (B11) must be included under ‘Additional research outputs’
- Inclusion of preprints or comparable resources within the body of the application should comply with standard disciplinary practices for the relevant field.
- Further preprint information can be found in the [ARC’s FT26 Instructions to Applicants](#).



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships

UQ Support and Strategic Information

FT26 – UQ Capacity Building Package

UQ is providing the following additional budget support:

- \$60,000 per year project costs, provided by UQ Central
- A UQ Graduate School PhD stipend of \$36,400 (2025\$) for 3.5 years, provided by the [Graduate School Fellowship Support Scheme](#) (conditions and caps are set by them)
- Any salary top-up required to meet the candidates UQ salary rate
 - *Please note, any additional loadings or allowances that form an individual's total salary package must be funded by the host Faculty/Institute/Centre/School.*

UQ Amplify: Introduction for FT26 Applicants

- Successful FT26 applicants can apply for an optional five-year post-fellowship appointment under [UQ Amplify](#) at the conclusion of their Fellowship.
- UQ Amplify is a strategic funding initiative that offers a centrally co-funded salary.
- It fosters greater career stability for researchers and access to the UQ teaching program.
- Those wishing to apply must undertake teaching activities during their fellowship including developing a teaching plan with a relevant School, undertaking any required professional development, and teaching at 20% of their FTE (from year two of the fellowship).

Applicant Benefits

- UQ Amplify is available for those who aren't on a continuing appointment and don't have another commitment to post-Fellowship transition
- UQ Amplify may not necessarily be the best fit for every eligible researcher.
- Standard UQ Amplify text in the UQ Letter of Support template marks UQ as a supportive research environment
- More information is available on RO [website](#) or via internalschemes@research.uq.edu.au.

FT26 – UQ Letter of Support (See C2)

It acts as a Letter of Introduction from UQ DVCRI's to the ARC's CEO

- Introduces you as a compelling person with a compelling research vision
- Outlines alignment to area/s of **core or emerging research strength**.
- Describes the **level of resources to be provided** to support the successful Candidate, including any in-kind contributions.
- Outlines **plans to retain the successful Future Fellow** in a continuing position, subject to appropriate performance during the Fellowship (see [UQ Amplify](#)).
- Where the Future Fellowship Candidate is an existing employee of UQ, describes how the **salary that was previously provided by UQ will be used**.
- (For proposals proposing less than 1.0 FTE on research activities) Detail how the time allocated to the administering institution over the life of the Future Fellowship will be used to **develop the candidate's career skills**.

FT26 – Research Office Useful Information

Research Office Future Fellowship Webpage (for dates, templates, how-to guide, FAQs)

<https://research.uq.edu.au/research-support/research-management/funding-schemes/australian-research-council-arc/arc-future-fellowships>

Research Office Team

- ARC@research.uq.edu.au

UQ Liaison Librarians

- <https://web.library.uq.edu.au/library-services/liaison-librarians>

Research Office Library of Successful Grants

- <https://research-support.uq.edu.au/resources-and-support/research-office/uq-library-successful-grants>

Where to go for FT examples?

Research Office Library of Successful Grants (*only available for Internal candidates*)

- <https://research-support.uq.edu.au/resources-and-support/research-office/uq-library-successful-grants>

This Research Office How-to Guide (selected examples of A4, Medical Statement, Project Description, ROPE)

- <https://research.uq.edu.au/research-support/research-management/funding-schemes/australian-research-council-arc/arc-future-fellowships>

Faculty and Institute Research Managers

- <https://research.uq.edu.au/research-support/research-management/faculty-and-institute-research-managers>.

Peer review

- expert and cognate
- Mentors – researchers are often amazingly generous with their time – don't be afraid to ask.

Where to go for help with metrics

Workshops (*only available for Internal candidates*)

- [Metrics for Grant Writing & Promotion](#)
- [Research Engagement and Impact evidence](#)

Online resources @ Metrics, Engagement & Impact

- [Online metrics tutorial](#) – guides researchers through how to gather metrics data from various sources to support your grant applications. Includes short ‘how to’ videos.
- Explore the [metrics](#) & [engagement and impact](#) webpages.

Key messages from the UQ Library

1. Make metrics work for you...provide context, be descriptive (and ensure dates & sources are recorded).
2. Ensure online profiles and researcher identifiers are up-to-date - make sure you have a populated ORCID.
<https://web.library.uq.edu.au/library-services/services-researchers/orcid-id-and-researcher-identifiers>
3. Contact the library – via a workshop or your Liaison Librarian – *the earlier the better!*
<https://web.library.uq.edu.au/library-services/contact-faculty-services-librarians>
4. Prepare a [data management plan](#) to support your ARC grant.

Preparing a data management plan for your successful project

ARC requirements

- All successful applicants for ARC grants will now be **required to prepare a data management plan** before the project starts. The Administering Organisation [UQ] will be required to retain the data management plan and provide it to the ARC upon request.
- <https://web.library.uq.edu.au/research-and-publish/manage-research-data/create-data-management-plan>

What is a data management plan?

- A plan describing how [research] data will be managed, preserved and shared with others (e.g. researchers, institutions, the broader public) as appropriate (NIH Data Management and Sharing Policy 2019)

ARC/NHMRC – Code for the Responsible Conduct of Research

- [Management of Data and Information in Research \(a Guide..\)](#)
- Guide outlines the key elements that should be addressed in a DMP

RDM Tools and Support @ UQ Library

- UQRDM (<https://guides.library.uq.edu.au/research-and-teaching-staff/uq-research-data-manager>)
 - stores all your research data in line with funder requirements
 - Fill in the form and download a **data management plan**
 - Instructions on [Library website](#)
- Library website – [Manage Research Data](#)
- [Checklist – Data Management Plan](#)
- [Library Training](#)
 - Best Practice in Research Data Management (via Staff Development/Workday)
 - UQRDM for researchers (create a DMP)
 - Managing Sensitive Data
 - Publishing your datasets with UQRDM



Contact
data@library.uq.edu.au



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships

Preparing your application and writing to sell yourself



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships

Application Form

Part A – Administrative Summary

Instructions to Applicants and RMS Help

We strongly recommend having a copy of the [ARC Instructions to Applicants](#) with you as you prepare the application – these answer many questions and also provide clarifying information not evident in the application form.

RMS Help

Wherever you see a blue information icon in RMS,  , additional information for that question is available. Just click on it!

A1. Application Title 

- The Application Title should be an accurate reflection of the research and will be visible to assessors.
- **Avoid** the use of acronyms and quotation marks.
- **Do not** use all upper case characters.
- The Application Title may be modified and used for public release.

*Provide a short title. (Up to 75 characters, approximately 10 words).
(This question must be answered)*

Future Fellowship 2026 Project

30 characters. 75 characters maximum.

A4 Application Summary

This section may be read by the ARC Accountable Authority and the Minister in conjunction with A5 when considering recommendations for funding.

The Application Summary should be written simply, clearly and in plain English (Australian Spelling) using aspirational terms ('the project aims to...') rather than definitive terms ('the project will...'). You should not use quotation marks, acronyms, all upper-case letters, or dot points. Do not use first person language.

Your A4 should follow the ARC required format:

- **Aims** (What do you plan to do?)
- **Significance** (Why is it important?)
- **Expected outcomes** (What will the project achieve once completed?)
- **Benefits** (Who/ what will benefit? Include benefits to Australia, and if possible, scope widely, include the general public/industry.

Do not list medical benefits unless it is very clear that they are downstream/beyond the scope of the Future Fellowship.

A4 Application Summary – Example 1*

*This project aims to*¹ investigate how the higher education sector can better support people with disabilities to transition from economic exclusion to work. One in five Australians have a disability and of these 47.3% are not employed. This is a significant issue² with regulatory failures and challenges often affecting rights to education and work being exercised on an equal basis. *This project seeks to examine*² international legal norms, theories and strategic and operational practices in the higher education sector. *Expected outcomes include*³ advances in scholarship on ableism, informed policy reform, and transferable operational processes for the education and employment sectors, *to improve the transition of people with disabilities to work*⁴.

1. Aims
2. Significance
3. Expected outcomes
4. Benefits

*A/Prof. Paul Harpur, successful Future Fellowship 2021 applicant

A4 Application Summary – Example 2*

*The aim of this theoretical physics project is to*¹ develop ultra-precise sensing capabilities for two main applications: ultrastable inertial sensors for improved navigation and gravimetry, and to search for signatures of quantum gravity. *This project expects to improve*² the performance of quantum sensors via the use of machine optimisation, and may lead to much-needed experimental data to help guide one of the most challenging problems in theoretical physics: the quantisation of gravity. *The expected outcomes of this project are*³ enhanced quantum sensor design, leading to improved inertial sensing technology. *This should provide benefits such as*⁴ improved capabilities for minerals exploration and monitoring the movement of ground water.

1. Aims
2. Significance
3. Expected outcomes
4. Benefits

**Dr Simon Haine, successful Future Fellowship 2021 applicant*

A5 National Interest Test Statement

These statements will be used by the ARC Accountable Authority and the Minister in considering the recommendation for funding. NITs will also be made available to the public if the application is successful.

The NIT statement must serve as a stand-alone statement and information provided in this section should be included elsewhere in the application as appropriate.

Applicants should:

- Use plain English (Australian Spelling), avoiding acronyms;
- Open with definition of problem then describe how the project will deliver benefits to Australia;
- Be careful not to overstate the outcomes of the research - be realistic;
- Clearly state the expected benefit to the **Australian community and beyond the Academic outcomes**. This needs to be more than the intrinsic value of undertaking the research, enhancing reputation and/or training researchers;
- Where possible, relate research to government initiatives/policies, industry or economic values;
- If the proposed research is about an international matter, strongly relate the research outcomes to Australia's role and the impact for Australia; and
- **Avoid medical outcomes**, unless clearly beyond the project's scope.

A5 National Interest Test Statement

See the ARC website for details (including examples) on [*Articulating National Interest in Grant Applications*](#). The Research office has also prepared a *UQ National Interest Test Writing Guide*, available on the [UQ Future Fellowships webpage](#).

The ARC has provided a list of considerations for what the NIT must address.

The considerations are:

- 1. What is the project about and what research gap is it addressing for Australia?** Describe the project in 1-2 sentences.
- 2. How could the research benefit Australians (economically, socially, environmentally, commercially, or culturally)?** What gap is it addressing?
- 3. How might you promote your research outcomes beyond academia** (economically, socially, environmentally, commercially or culturally) **to maximise understanding, translation, use, and adoption of the research in the future?** How might the research be used? For example, are there conditions that would need to be in place for the outcome to occur? If so, briefly describe them.

Applicants should address these considerations as a single cohesive statement. Applicants should take particular care in addressing each element concisely - the statement should be approximately 200 words and must be understood by a member of the general public.



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships

Application Form

Part B – Participant Details including ROPE

B1: Personal Details - ARC Conflict of Interest

- The [ARC Conflict of Interest and Confidentiality Policy](#) was updated in 2020 to include *material personal interest*.
- **Researchers need to update their RMS Person Profile (Section B in application form) when applying for ARC research funding** to address the following questions:
 1. Are you currently receiving any financial support (cash or in-kind) for research related activities from a country other than Australia?
 2. Are you currently, or have you previously been, associated or affiliated with a talent recruitment program from a country other than Australia?
 3. Are you currently associated or affiliated with a government, intelligence organisation, government owned enterprise, military, or police organisation in a country other than Australia?
 4. Have you identified and disclosed any conflicts of interests in accordance with your Institution's conflict of interest policies and procedures?
 5. Has the candidate acknowledged the collection of personal information by the ARC? Are you receiving any foreign financial support (cash or in-kind) for research related activities?
- Check that the answers in B1 are up to date – these are automatically populated from your RMS profile
- A researcher may choose not to respond but will not be able to participate or submit an application to the ARC.

B6: Research Opportunity and Performance Evidence (ROPE) – Career Interruptions

- ARC recognises [career interruptions](#) can have a significant impact on the period between conferral of a researcher's PhD, and a subsequent application for ARC funding.
- *This question does not relate to the participant's eligibility for the scheme, please see [B14-B16](#) for eligibility exemption information.*
- This is where you can quantify any [significant interruptions](#) relating to [career and/or life experiences](#), which have [affected your research capacity, productivity or contribution](#).
- This may be in conjunction with an eligibility exemption request if needed, or stand alone to provide the reviewers with commensurate time you haven't been research active.
- Refer to the [ARC ROPE Statement](#) for more information on filling out this section.

Eligible Career Interruptions

Eligible career interruptions	Period of time that can be claimed
• Disruption due to international relocation	A period of time commensurate with the interruption, not exceeding 3 months per international relocation.
• Caring responsibilities • Disability • Disaster management and recovery • Limited or no access to facilities and resources (e.g. workplace interruptions) • Medical conditions • Non-research positions, <u>not concurrent</u> with research employment • Parental leave • Unemployment	A period of time commensurate with the interruption.
• Primary carer of a dependent child	Up to two-years, <u>inclusive of parental leave</u> , for each dependent child.

B7: ROPE - Career Narrative

- This section gives you the opportunity to briefly **explain the opportunities** you have had in your career and **give context to interruptions and other considerations** to your career journey.
- You should use this space to explain your career interruptions and other responsibilities you have experienced. ARC recommends you:
 - Provide details of any periods of research only employment and any periods of research leave;
 - Give a representative summary of the formal allocations of research, teaching and administrative responsibilities across your career.
- Do not include information provided elsewhere in the application (e.g., [B8](#)).

B8: ROPE - Evidence of the participant's research impact and contributions to the field (PDF upload)

The RO provides a [template](#) that complies with the ARC's requirements.

B8 must be a maximum of **one A4 page**.

- Provide a statement outlining evidence of the Future Fellowship candidate's research impact and significant contributions to the field.
- Describe how the Future Fellowship candidate's research has led to a significant change or advance of knowledge in their field and outline how this will contribute to this application.
- This section should be devoted to evidence of research impact and contributions to the field that are not research outputs as this is covered in [B10](#) and [B11](#).

Describe to the assessor:

- What was the state of play before and after your research?
- What did *you* do that was novel?
- What outcomes/impact has been seen, and/or is there evidence for translation/uptake of your research (evidence base)

B8: ROPE - Writing Tips

- This section should be written in a way that best tells your story and focuses on your strongest points.
- Each sentence must **sell you as a future leader**.
- Writing your ROPE for a Fellowship is not the same as writing ROPE for a Discovery Project.
- Use white space strategically. Use sub-headings to direct the assessor's attention.
- Outline your achievements and significant contributions to the field and explain how your research has led to a **significant change or advance of knowledge** in your field
- Include commentary on how your achievements and contributions will contribute to the current Future Fellowship application, demonstrating your **capacity to deliver**.
- Use **evidence-based** answers accessible to the intelligent non-specialist

B9: ROPE – Mentoring and Leadership

- Provide a statement outlining any evidence of the Future Fellowship candidate's leadership and mentoring capability, including details of their experience and achievements in research training and supervision (up to 750 characters, or approximately 100 words).
- Describe how the Future Fellowship candidate has provided mentorship to nurture early-career researchers and how this will position the candidate to continue leadership and mentorship throughout the fellowship.

ARC suggestions:

Provide clear information that outlines evidence of your opportunities and achievements in leadership, mentoring and research training or supervision. The information provided should help assessors understand the quality of your achievements and capability against this criterion, but not repeat information already provided in this application.

It is helpful to include information such as how you have supported others in leadership roles you have held; your mentoring experience or approach; and details of your graduate student load and completions, and/or your role in supporting graduate student achievements.

B10: ROPE – Research Outputs Context

Research Context (200 words):

- Contextualize the importance of different research outputs and expectations in the Future Fellowship candidate's discipline.
- Be careful not to repeat information provided elsewhere in the application (E.g. [B8](#)).
- **Outline your publication track record:** Highlight first/last authorship, esteem of journals where you published in your field, specific indicators of recognition within your field (citations, authorship order conventions, hot papers, metrics indicators).
- **Include other highlights** (e.g., international collaboration, cross discipline working, significance of non-traditional research outputs etc.).

The UQ Library has an updated [Research Impact and Metrics page](#), with information on various aspects of bibliometrics to source information and data for inclusion into your application.

We recommend using as many of the libraries' tools as possible to ensure you include, and reference metrics to the best of your ability.

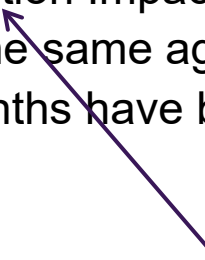
B10: ROPE - Research Output Context

Example 1

My research seeks to understand and inform the design, implementation and governance of environmental policy instruments. I have a particular interest in the use of market-based instruments for biodiversity conservation and climate change mitigation and adaptation. My research spans both natural and social sciences, hence my publication record reflects a combination of scholarly norms and indicators of research excellence. I use an interdisciplinary and mixed methods approach, and have published in the fields of conservation science, public policy, and environmental economics.

My publication record is exceptional for a researcher at my career stage (PhD conferred 1.3 years ago, December 2017). My h-index is 15 (according to SciVal, March 2019), and I have accrued 551 citations since 2011 (SciVal, March 2019). My papers have a Field Weighted Citation Impact of 3.41, meaning they are being cited 3.41 times more than the world average for publications of the same age and discipline . All of my peer-reviewed contributions that have been published for at least 6 months have been cited.

**Dr Megan Evans*



Show your citations in the context of your discipline

B10: ROPE - Research Output Context

Example 2

I have published 21 peer-reviewed articles in internationally renowned journals. 90.5% of these papers are in journals rated in the top 25% of their field by ISI impact factor, and 9 papers are in the top 5% cited papers (field weighted). My publications feature in Conservation Letters (IF 7.279, 2/57 in ISI Biodiversity Conservation), Conservation Biology (IF 5.89, 3/57 in ISI Biodiversity Conservation), Current Opinion in Environmental Sustainability (IF 4.186, 43/242 in ISI Environmental Sciences), Methods in Ecology and Evolution (IF 6.36, 9/158 in ISI Ecology) and Frontiers in Ecology and the Environment (IF 8.302, 5/242 in ISI Environmental Sciences). I have also published 4 journal editorials and comments, including two lead author Correspondence pieces in Nature (IF: 41.5, 1/64 in ISI Multidisciplinary Sciences) and Nature Ecology & Evolution.

Contextualise the esteem of journals you published in in relation to your field

It is good to highlight hot-papers, especially where you are the lead/last author

B10: ROPE - Research Output Context

Example 3

I am the lead author on 8 of my 21 peer-reviewed articles . Two of these contributions are single-authored, which is uncommon in the natural sciences, but an indicator of scholarly maturity and esteem in the social sciences. Of the papers where I am not lead author, I am usually second or third author (10 papers) due to my extensive intellectual and methodological contributions to the projects. I am the senior author on one peer-reviewed article. Co-authors on my publications span four continents (North America, Europe, Africa, and Australia). My research frequently generates considerable interest in traditional and social media outlets. Fourteen (14) of my publications are in the top 5% of all research outputs scored by Altmetric, including my recent article in Palgrave Communications which has an Altmetric score of 563, is the top-rated contribution in that journal, has been tweeted 933 times, and featured in 6 online blogs and news sites since July 2018. My work has been featured in Nature News, Radio National, ABC News, Brisbane Times, SBS News, the London School of Economics Impact Blog and the online science news site Particle. I have published 9 articles in The Conversation which have attracted 61,504 readers across Australia, the United States, France, the UK, and Canada since 2011.

Demonstrate leadership of projects

Highlight international collaboration

Demonstrate commitment to non-traditional outputs and the value/reach of these outputs

B11: ROPE – 10 Career-best Research Outputs

- The data will be populated from the 'Research Outputs' section your RMS profile. For instructions on how to add research outputs to your profile in RMS, refer to the User Guide - [Research Outputs in RMS Instructions for adding Research Outputs to your RMS Profile](#).
- List 10 career-best outputs. These can include Authored books; Edited books; Book chapters; Refereed Journal articles; Fully refereed conference proceedings; Additional research outputs. CVs and theses should not be included. For information on what the ARC defines as a Research Output, refer to the [ARC Open Access Policy](#).
 - Select which 10 outputs to include in the application: click on the 'Search' button. tick the 'Select' checkbox or the 'Select all' button. Click on 'Add selected' button. To remove the research output from the listing click on the 'Remove' button.
 - Ensure each output is fully referenced.
 - Rank your top 10 outputs by entering 1 (highest rank) to 10 (lowest rank) in "Rank" column.
 - Identify those most relevant to your application by ticking the "relevant" checkbox.
 - CVs and theses should not be included in this list.

We suggest considering research impact alongside a balanced demonstration of your expertise and feasibility for the proposed the project when choosing your top 10.

B11: ROPE – 10 Career-best Research Outputs

Preprints

- [Preprints or comparable resources](#) can be included in the Research Output list but **must** be entered as “Additional research output”. If preprints or comparable resources are cited, these should be **explicitly identified in B11** by including “[PREPRINT OR COMPARABLE]” after the reference.
- Preprints or comparable resources must be added **manually** in your RMS profile. Refer to the User Guide - [Research Outputs in RMS Instructions for adding Research Outputs to your RMS Profile](#).
- The reference should include a DOI, URL or equivalent, version number where available and/or date of access, as applicable.

Brief instructions for manually adding a preprint or comparable resource in your RMS profile:

- Navigate to RMS user profile → Manage Research Outputs. Select ‘Additional Research Output’, then select “Yes” under “Free Form Citation”.
- Enter relevant text and date (Month and Year). The citation text will allow up to 4000 characters.
- Add “[PREPRINT OR COMPARABLE]” at the end of the citation.
- Click “Save”.
- The citation will display in the Manage Outputs list.

B11: Research Outputs Annotation

- For each output you add to B11, you will have a text box which allows up to 150 characters, approximately 20 words annotation per output. Use this box to provide context and impact of each output.
- We suggest considering research impact alongside a balanced demonstration of your expertise and feasibility for the proposed the project when choosing your top 10 career-best research outputs.
- For Example:
 - “This publication showed <X>. This has been adopted in/by <Y>.”
 - “This paper demonstrates capacity in <X> and has been cited <Z> times.”
 - “This <non-traditional research output> has been adopted into <Y>, where it has had <X impact>.”
 - “This publication showed <X>. This work has been cited <Z> times in <Y> disciplines.”

B14-16: Eligibility Period Extension

If you received your PhD before 1 March 2011, you will need to apply for an Eligibility Exemption detailing your commensurate career interruptions to ascertain your eligibility to apply for FT26.

- Career interruptions must
 - align with the [approved ARC eligible interruptions](#);
 - be significant (at least one month);
 - not overlap; and
 - occur after the conferral of your PhD (or equivalent).
- Eligibility Exemptions must be **approved and certified by UQ's DVCR**.
- **Eligibility Exemption Requests are due to UQ R&I by the internal close date (6 October 2025).**
The requisite forms are on the [UQ Future Fellowships webpage](#).
- You will need to provide evidence for each interruption. Further information on what evidence to provide is included in the eligibility exemption forms.

B17: Professional equivalent to a PhD

- If you do not hold a PhD, please contact our office at ARC@research.uq.edu.au **as soon as possible** so your degree can be deemed equivalent by the UQ Graduate School
 - Once confirmed, you will need to answer 'Yes' to this question to indicate that it has been certified by UQ.
- **If you hold a PhD, answer 'No' to this question.**

B18: FT26 Salary Level

- The correct Future Fellowship Salary Level must be selected according to the Future Fellowship candidate's **current** academic level at the **application close date**.
 - *E.g. A candidate is applying into FT26 (application close 5 November 2025). They were recently promoted to Level C effective 1 January 2026. They should select Level B on their application.*
- **The level selected at B18 must be correlate with the Level Selected at D1.**
- If applying from outside Australia, please ensure that the appropriate equivalent Australian academic level is selected and corresponds to the Future Fellowship level of the application.

Selection at B18	Selection at D1
Level A	Future Fellowship Level 1 Salary Level
Level B	
Level C	Future Fellowship Level 2 Salary Level
Level D	Future Fellowship Level 3 Salary Level
Level E	



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships

Application Form

Part C – Project Description

C1: Project Description

ARC has a strict 7-page limit.

The RO provides a [template](#) that complies with the ARC's requirements for this document. **Use the UQ template for required headings, order, and formatting.**

Please consider the following points when crafting your Project Description:

- The ARC heading structure must be retained; subheadings may be useful to direct assessors' attention.
- Prominence of your Aims on the first page may engage assessors' interest early in your Project Description.
- Consider the assessment criteria weightings alongside the length of sections in your C1.
- Think about readability for assessors who are reviewing a lot of applications, and panel members who may be given 5 minutes to familiarise themselves with your proposal.
 - Consider using sub-headings to direct the assessors' attention
 - Utilise 'white space' to break up large blocks of text
 - ARC recommends minimum 12 pt body font and 10 pt font in figure/tables/references. *We will request written confirmation from you if font sizes are smaller than the recommendation.*
 - A timeline is a good way to visually represent feasibility.
- [Preprints or comparable resources](#) can be cited C1 but must be **explicitly identified** by including [PREPRINT OR COMPARABLE] after the reference. This reference should include a DOI, URL or equivalent, version number where available and/or date of access, as applicable. This indication is only required in the reference list and not in the project description itself.

Project description and Assessment criteria

- It is important to note that the Assessment criteria for Future Fellowships are each assessed across the whole of your application.
- While some of the criteria align largely with C1 with related headings (i.e. Project Quality and Innovation; and Benefit), they will be assessed over multiple parts of your application and lack of these headings does not mean they won't be assessed in C1.
- We recommend you familiarise yourself with how each Assessment Criteria is considered. This is outlined in the [Grant Guidelines](#).

Assessment Criteria	Weighting	Primary points of consideration (examples only)
Investigator(s)/Capability	50%	ROPE (Part B), C1, C2, Part D (funding for additional staff and students)
Project Quality and Innovation	25%	A4, A5, C1, E6-7
Benefit	15%	A4, A5, C1, Part E
Feasibility	10%	All sections (see next slide)

Project Feasibility

- *Part C1 Project Description* does not have a required feasibility heading. The feasibility should be considered throughout your application
- Assessors tend to comment on the following points:
 - Investigators/collaborators area of expertise aligning with project. Align ROPE, C1 and C2.
 - Do the investigators have the time and capacity to complete the project? Discuss in C2.
 - Timeline:
 - Can the project be done in the proposed timeframe? Consider adding a timeline in project description (C1).
 - Budget (Part D)
 - Is the requested funding enough to complete the project? Is it appropriate?
 - Does the budget represent good value-for-money?
 - Resources/facilities and institutional support
 - Are the facilities and resources necessary to complete the project available to the fellow?
 - If you are including HDR students, will they be provided a suitable environment for training and contribution to the project? What will the students' role in the project be?

C1: Writing Tips from successful Future Fellows and College of Experts

College of Experts members consistently advise that **readability** of the Project Description is very important for their assessment of the project.

Successful Future Fellow applications often:

- Include a timeline (in Project Quality and innovation section)
- Effectively use subheadings and white space to guide the reader's eyes.
- Limit technical language to the understanding of an intelligent non-expert.
- Use dedicated subheadings in Project Quality and Innovation for:
 - Research Aims – clearly indicated on the first page
 - Project Significance
 - Project Innovation

Sample C1 Project Description

Note: Headings shown here are from FT23.

Please use the FT26 headings per the [UQ C1 template](#).

D1 Project Description

PROJECT TITLE

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet ut nonummy.

PROJECT AIMS AND BACKGROUND

Aims

Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Mauris et orci. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Proin pharetra nonummy pede.

Aenean nec lorem. In porttitor. Donec laoreet nonummy augue.

1. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies.
2. Proin pharetra nonummy pede.
3. Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Mauris et orci.

Background

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna eros quis urna...

INVESTIGATOR/CAPABILITY

Research Opportunity and Performance Evidence

Research outputs

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna eros quis urna.

Evidence of research training, mentoring and supervision

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed.

National/international research standing

Nunc viverra imperdiet enim. Fusce est. Vivamus a tellus. Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Mauris et orci.

Capability of Candidate to Build Collaboration in Australia and Internationally

Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.

PROJECT QUALITY AND INNOVATION

Conceptual Framework, Design and Methods

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna eros quis urna.

Significance

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna eros quis urna.

Innovation

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna eros quis urna.

Collaborations

Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Maecenas porttitor congue massa. Fusce posuere, magna sed pulvinar ultricies, purus lectus malesuada libero, sit amet commodo magna eros quis urna.

BENEFIT

Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Mauris et orci. Aenean nec lorem. In porttitor. Donec laoreet nonummy augue.

Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.

FEASIBILITY

Evidence of Supportive Environment

Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Mauris et orci.

Aenean nec lorem. In porttitor. Donec laoreet nonummy augue.

Cost Effectiveness

Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.

Timeline

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Aim 1			
Aim 2			
Aim 3			

COMMUNICATION OF RESULTS

Pellentesque habitant morbi tristique senectus et netus et malesuada fames ac turpis egestas. Proin pharetra nonummy pede. Mauris et orci.



Figure 1: Lorem Ipsum

Aenean nec lorem. In porttitor. Donec laoreet nonummy augue.

Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.

REFERENCES

1. Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.
2. Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.
3. Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.
4. Suspendisse dui purus, scelerisque at, vulputate vitae, pretium mattis, nunc. Mauris eget neque at sem venenatis eleifend. Ut nonummy.

Aims up front, box for emphasis

Sub-headings used to direct assessors attention

Use of 'white space' so assessor isn't faced with a wall of text

Figure captions and text inside figure meets font size (10pt) requirement

Timeline included

References are one column, can be size 10 pt

Acknowledgements heading removed when unneeded

C1: Project Quality and Innovation

Consider starting with a **preamble** giving the **big picture vision and goals** of your fellowship project. Some suggested sub-headings are below:

Background:

- Explain the problems that your project is trying to address – why should the reader want these problems solved?
- Outline the relevant key national and international progress to date, position your work (works/major papers you have been involved in) in that landscape
- Explain the breakthroughs needed to solve the problem and clearly link your fellowship project to addressing that problem/delivering those breakthroughs.

Aims: we recommend having aims clearly visible on the first page!

- Give your aims appropriate prominence early on so that reviewers understand what you are hoping to achieve and can read the rest of your proposal with that context in mind.
- What are the major research questions/aims?
- How does the aim of the research program contribute to/address an important gap in knowledge, or problem?
- Consider placing a box or shaded area around your aims to draw reviewers' attention to them.

C1: Project Quality and Innovation

Suggested sub-headings continued:

Significance:

- **How** is the work novel? **What** makes the work ground-breaking?
- **why** is the work important, **why** is the project essential to progress the field, **what** impact will the project have on the field/generation of new knowledge, **how** will others benefit from the project?

Innovation:

- How will the innovation of the project lead to better outcomes for the problem/gap in knowledge?
- How is the research program innovative in the context of recent international advances in research in this area?
- why the project is **original** and **innovative**; **what** new methods are you employing? **How** will it push boundaries?
- Try to avoid incremental language (expand, advance, build) and instead use transformational language
 - E.g. how will your project transform, synthesise, change the direction, or introduce a step change in this area?

Note: Articulate and differentiate the **significance** (why is the work/problem important?) and the **innovation** (how will the project advance the knowledge base?)

C1: Project Quality and Innovation

Suggested sub-headings continued:

Project Design:

- Describe key aspects of the project design, including conceptual framework and methods, and why this approach was selected.
- Ensure your project design and implementation plan is clear and cohesive, and links back to your aims
- Does the project involve research pertaining to Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities? If yes, describe the strategies for enabling collaboration, and the extent of relationships and personal affiliations with such communities.
- To what extent will the research enhance international collaboration?
- Demonstrate the cost-effectiveness and feasibility of the project design. Timelines are a great visual tool for this.

Tip: Make sure your Hypothesis and/or research questions are clearly stated in your project description.

C1: Benefit

Consider what benefits your project might bring:

New or advanced knowledge: Start by highlighting what new knowledge the Future Fellowship will generate.

Expected benefits:

- Benefits can be relevant to the Australian, or international communities of research: economic, commercial, environmental, social and/or cultural.
- These are the same categories as at **A5**; however, here you can expand to include international benefits, advancing Australia's intellectual leadership/position in the discipline itself, providing research training and opportunities for students, and forming strong collaborations and networks.
- Unlike A5 academic benefits can be included here: research training and opportunities for students and early-career researchers (ECRs), forming strong research collaborations and networks (be they national or international).

Australian Government Priorities: If appropriate, describe the potential contribution to capacity in an announced Australian Government's priority area. This should align with E1 where relevant.

C1: Mentoring and Capacity Building

- How does your expertise align with the aims of the project?
- How will the project advance national and/or international leadership in this field? Will you be collaborating with any other researchers to enhance capacity in the field?
- How will the project advance the candidate's mentoring and research training?

C1: Communication of Results

- How will the results of the research program be communicated?
 - Do you plan to communicate findings to the research field?
 - How will your findings be communicated to the general public, industries, government, or relevant sectors?
 - Consider pathways to translation. How will you foster translation during your Fellowship?
 - This section should demonstrate how you will communicate results to both research/academic communities, and the wider public.

Ensure any costs claimed for communication of results in Part D - Project Cost is reflected here in C1.

C2: UQ Letter of Support

Writing your Letter of Support

1. The RO provides a template containing prompts for content – max 2 pages. No “one size fits all” approach - must be about **you and your fit** to the UQ research strengths/research strategy.
2. Future Fellowship Candidate to **draft the body of Statement** (with input from School/Faculty/Institute).
3. **Full draft Statement** to be included when the application is submitted internally for RO review.
4. The RO will provide **comments** on the Statement, and any further suggestions for improvement.
5. Final Letter of Support will be reviewed and approved before submission to the ARC.

C2: UQ Letter of Support

Part to the LoS	What to describe
1. Introduction	• An Executive Summary of the Candidate and their achievements • Crafted to emphasise how <i>your</i> work has been influential in its field • 2-3 paragraphs
2. Alignment with UQ Core or Emerging Research Strengths	• Fit of person with UQ's strategic vision • How does The Person and The Project fit with, and complement, The Place • What is the value-add? • Alignment with future plans/strategies for growth of research area at UQ



C2: UQ Letter of Support

Part to the LoS	What to describe
3. Research Environment including support of the Candidate	• Positioning of the Fellow in a quality research environment (collaborative ... intellectual and physical/infrastructural resources). • Alignment with specific expertise of UQ researchers and/or collaborators working in areas of strength. • How the Fellow will complement, enhance and extend UQ research capacity and profile? • Level of support for the Candidate (e.g., salary top-up, PhD students, project costs) with template text on UQ <i>Capacity Building Package</i> • How the salary that was previously provided UQ will be used where the candidate is an existing employee;



C2: UQ Letter of Support

Part to the LoS	What to describe
4. Capacity Building and Post-Fellowship retention plan	• <i>“Outline plans to retain the Future Fellowship Candidate in a continuing position...”</i> • Evidence of institutional plan to integrate the Fellow into UQ’s research development of this field • How will this Fellowship + post-fellowship employment develop the research capacity of the Candidate? • If you are a continuing UQ employee, strongly justify why award a Fellowship and why now – never ‘more time to do more of the same’; and describe how the salary previously provided by UQ is to be used?



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2026 ARC Future Fellowships

Application Form

Part D – Project Cost

D1 Project Costs

Please consider the following when developing your budget:

- The salary level entered must align with level selected at [B18](#).
- Your ARC budget must not exceed \$60,000 in any year plus your salary amount (varies by level);
- The UQ Graduate School PhD stipend should be entered as 3.5 years at \$36,400 p.a. (three years at \$36,400 and last year at \$18,200)
- Additional PhD stipends requested from ARC will require a stipend top-up from your UQ project costs
- Your UQ budget must not exceed \$ 36,400 + \$60,000 in Years 1-3 and \$18,200 + \$60,000 in Year 4, unless you have additional confirmed cash commitments;
- Budget items can be split across ARC and UQ where needed (e.g., to remain in budget limits);
- In-kind contributions, or contributions from other organisations should not be included at D1.
- Do not include GST or indexation in your budget.

The RO has a Budget Tool (available from the [FT26 webpage](#)) to assist you to build your budget into RMS formatting.

D1 Project Costs – RO Budget Tool

To calculate Future Fellow ARC Salary Level

1. Select the Fellow's **current** UQ Salary level (at time of application) to populate the correct ARC Salary Level.
2. The correct FT26 salary and any UQ salary gap will auto-populate in the budget table.

Future Fellow name:								
Current Salary Level:	C4		Choose Salary Level to populate FT salary in budget table					

BUDGET TABLE	Year 1		Year 2		Year 3		Year 4	
	ARC	Admin Org	ARC	Admin Org	ARC	Admin Org	ARC	Admin Org
PERSONNEL (itemise all Personnel/roles and enter all lines in RMS)								
(Future Fellowship)	\$232,091	\$0	\$232,091	\$0	\$232,091	\$0	\$232,091	\$0
Higher Degree Research Stipend (UQ Capacity Building Package)		\$36,400		\$36,400		\$36,400		\$18,200
Example Format: Research Position (e.g. Postdoctoral Research Associate), Appointment Level (A6), 0.75 FTE,								

D1 Project Costs – RO Budget Tool

To calculate additional staff salary

1. Use the Salary Calculator for academic and professional staff.
2. Enter staff description and salary rate/s into Personnel section.

Note: Additional ARC-funded HDR students may be added to the budget table in RMS via “Add Participant Type”. The [ARC HDR stipend rate](#) is \$33,533 per year (2025\$) with a \$2,867 gap payment required from your UQ project funds.

BUDGET TABLE	Year 1		Year 2		Year 3		Year 4	
	ARC	Admin Org	ARC	Admin Org	ARC	Admin Org	ARC	Admin Org
PERSONNEL (<i>itemise all Personnel/roles and enter all lines in RMS</i>)								
(Future Fellowship)	\$232,091	\$0	\$232,091	\$0	\$232,091	\$0	\$232,091	\$0
Higher Degree Research Stipend (UQ Capacity Building Package)		\$36,400		\$36,400		\$36,400		\$18,200
Example Format: Research Position (e.g. Postdoctoral Research Associate), Appointment Level (A6), 0.75 FTE,	\$103,636							

SALARY CALCULATOR	Salary level	FTE/Hours	Salary rate inc on-costs
Academic salary (FTE)	A6	0.75	103,636
Ongoing Professional salary (FTE)			0
Casual Professional salary (hours)			0

D1 Project Costs – RO Budget Tool

The totals (blue rows) in each category are the values you enter into your RMS budget table (D1)

Check your yearly project costs do not exceed the ARC and UQ contributions of \$60,000 each, unless you have confirmed additional contributions*.

*Any additional UQ cash contributions will need to be confirmed in writing and provided to the Research Office

TRAVEL (itemize budget items for yearly total and justification BUT <i>only</i> enter the TOTAL for each year into RMS)									
Total Travel Request and Contribution	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
FIELD RESEARCH (only enter the TOTAL for each year into RMS)									
Total Field Research Request and Contribution	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
EQUIPMENT (only enter the TOTAL for each year into RMS)									
Total Equipment Request and Contribution	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
MAINTENANCE (only enter the TOTAL for each year into RMS)									
Total Maintenance Request and Contribution	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
OTHER (only enter the TOTAL for each year into RMS)									
Total Other Request and Contribution	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
PROJECT GRAND TOTALS	\$232,091	\$36,400	\$232,091	\$36,400	\$232,091	\$36,400	\$232,091	\$18,200	
PROJECT COST TOTALS (excl salary and UQ PhD)	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0

Check your Travel allowance does not exceed the \$100,000 limit

Travel Allowance Check

Max allowed for whole project is \$100,000

\$0

Cells in this row will highlight RED if the total project costs exceed the allowed annual limit from the ARC (\$60,000pa) or UQ (\$60,000pa)

Entering details into D1 Project Costs

Personnel

- Item description should include job title, FTE/number of hours/number of weeks, salary level and “+ 30% on-costs”, e.g. ‘Research Assistant (HEW5) @1.0FTE + 30% on-costs’; refer to [UQ FT26 Budget Tool](#) for the correct salary amounts.
- Include a 3.5-year PhD stipend contributed by UQ at \$36,400 p.a. (2025\$), e.g., ‘HDR stipend – UQ Capacity Building Package’.
- If you request an ARC Funded HDR stipend in addition to the UQ provided stipend, you will need to top-up the ARC rate, \$33,533pa, to the UQ rate, \$36,400pa, from your *UQ Capacity Building Package* (\$2,867pa/\$10,034 total).
- Note that support staff may be a good way to use additional funds if you can justify the position well.

Entering details into D1 Project Costs

Travel and Field Research

- The yearly total should be entered as a single line item in D1, ie *Travel for the project*, and then itemised in the budget justifications, D2/D3
- Keep your essential *Travel* costs below \$100,000 over the life of the project, in accordance with the ARC requirements.
 - NB: Travel and accommodation costs related to carrying out field research or carer's costs are not included in this \$100,000 limit.*
- D2/D3 should be itemised by trip or site visit, e.g.,
 - International conference \$X,XXX, Fellow and student, incl. airfare/accomm./per diem
 - Western Australia field work 10 days, incl. flights, specially kitted hire car, camping, accommodation and meals

Description	ARC	Admin Org
	Cash	Cash
Total	282,795	93,075
Personnel	262,795	74,845
Dr XXXX XXXX (Future Fellowship)	222,950	
Research Associate (A06) @0.6FTE + 30% on-costs	39,845	39,845
Higher Degree Research Stipend		36,400
Travel	4,000	1,020
Travel for the project	4,000	1,020
Field Research		
Field Research for the project		
Equipment		
Equipment for the project		
Maintenance	16,000	17,210
Maintenance for the project	16,000	17,210
Other		
Other costs for the project		

Entering details into D1 Project Costs - Cont'd

Equipment (costs associated with equipment and installation)

- The yearly total should be entered as a single line item in D1, and then itemised in the budget justifications, D2/D3
- Use quoted *Equipment* costs, not estimates and keep the quotes on file
- Laptops are considered basic equipment and must not be requested from ARC funding. If a field work specific laptop is required, it may be funded from your *UQ Capacity Building Package*.
- UQ contribution is expected for large items of equipment.

Maintenance (consumables and items related to equipment maintenance)

- The yearly total should be entered as a single line item in D1, and then itemised in the budget justifications, D2/D3

Other (costs that don't fit in another category)

- The yearly total should be entered as a single line item in D1, and then itemised in the budget justifications, D2/D3
- May include reasonable essential extraordinary costs to allow a participant who is a carer, or who requires care/assistance, to undertake travel essential to the project; and
- May include publication/dissemination costs, third party services, web hosting, etc.

D2: Justification of funding requested from the ARC

The RO provide a [template](#) that complies with the ARC's requirements for D2. **Maximum 3 pages.**

Please consider the following points when crafting your D2:

- Each item must be fully justified in terms of need and cost, as the ARC may cut requested items from successful budgets.
 - E.g. “To achieve aim B, a full-time HEW 5.1 research assistant with experience in X, Y and Z is required for years 1-3”.
- Line items should be presented *in the order that they are presented in the D1 budget* (when viewing your application PDF) to enable ease of cross referencing between D1 and D2 for the assessors;
- Noting the year each budget line is requested in (i.e., Year 1, Year 2, etc.) helps reviewers more easily cross reference with D1;
- Use the same headings as in the Description Column in the D1 budget table, e.g. *Personnel, Travel, Field Research, Equipment, Maintenance, Other*.

D2: Justification of funding requested from the ARC – Cont'd

Personnel:

- All personnel (except the Future Fellowship candidate's salary) must be justified
- Justify what the person will do and how that matches their level (PhD student, HEW level, academic level etc.)
- Note that 30% on-costs have been budgeted in line with the ARC's requirements

Travel and Field Research:

- Justify the need (how will the travel benefit the Future Fellowship project/candidate, what will the outcomes be); and
- Justify the cost (breakdown of your total trip cost).

Equipment:

- Justify why you need the equipment, not just the cost; and
- Make clear that the cost is quoted, not just an estimate, including supplier, quote price and make/model of the equipment where practicable.
- For expensive pieces of equipment, demonstrate that access to such equipment housed elsewhere is not practical.

D2: Justification of funding requested from the ARC – Cont'd

Maintenance & Other:

- Justify why you need the budget items, not just the cost
- Make clear that the cost is quoted/actual, not just an estimate

D2: Example Justifications

Casual Research Assistant 1.0 FTE 12 weeks HEW5.1 + 30% on-costs – Year 3

A salary for a casual Research Assistant has been budgeted to provide support in data clean-up and analysis for work stream 4. It is estimated that eight weeks of full-time work is required in Year 3 to achieve project outcomes within the proposed timeframe. The appointee will require a combination of relevant experience and/or education/training that will equip them with the ability to perform data clean-up functions and run basic analysis in R under the supervision of the Future Fellow. The skills required are commensurate with a Research Assistant (HEW Level 5) according to UQ's Classification Guidelines for Research-Related General Staff Positions (HEW Levels 1 - 9). 30% on-costs have been included in the budgeted cost.

Year 3: \$26,458

ARC Total: \$26,458

Ecological Statistician 0.2 FTE 2 months Level D4 + 30% on-costs – Year 3

A salary for an Ecological Statistician has been budgeted to provide statistical support for the analysis of Work Stream 3 during the final year. It is estimated that the statistician will be required for 2 months at 0.2FTE. The appointee will require extensive experience as in ecological modelling, conducting analyses on camera on behavioural and ecological data and the use of MARXAN. The skills required are commensurate with a Level D4. 30% on-costs have been included in the budgeted cost.

Year 3: \$7,009

ARC Total: \$7,009

Fellow travel to ICCB, France (registration, flights, accommodation, daily allowance) 14 days – Year 3

This is a significant conference in the field. Presentation and networking at this conference provides me with the chance to improve my international collaborative network to directly benefit the project and improve Australia's research capacity. I will stay on for an extra 3 days after the conference (as budgeted) to ensure there is time for meetings with current and potential collaborators that will add value to this project, and my future research endeavours. Attendance will allow me to stay informed about current developments and trends within the field.

The cost breakdown is as follows:

1 x return airfare to Paris: \$2,000

Conference registration: \$500

Accommodation x 14 days (\$150/day): \$2,100

Food and incidentals allowance x 14 days (\$100/day): \$1,400

Year 3: \$6,000

ARC Total: \$6,000

Use the RO [template](#) to ensure you build on the correct format required for this document.

Satellite Phone- Year 1

Due to the remote nature of the field work being carried out, the team will require a satellite phone for field work. The phone will be utilised for daily (or more frequent depending on the safety protocol) check-ins as well as to contact people for assistance in the event of unplanned occurrences and emergency situations. An Iridium Extreme satellite phone has been quoted at \$1,750 from Amazon.

Year 1: \$1,750

ARC Total: \$1,750

Weather Station - Data Logger (Davis Instruments) – Year 1

To ensure the accurate collection of weather data at our field site we will be required to deploy a weather station with data logging capacity. The weather station will need to record hourly temperatures, rainfall, wind speed and direction and will need to have capacity for up to one year of data to be stored between downloads. As there are no weather stations within the proposed field site we will need to purchase this equipment. A Davis Instruments Data Logging Weather Station has been quoted at \$2,785 (Davis Instruments), there will be not installation costs as the DECRA team will install it onsite during the FNQ Data Collection field trip in Year 1.

Year 1: \$2,785

ARC Total: \$2,785

D3: Details of non-ARC contributions

The RO provide a [template](#) that complies with the ARC's requirements for this document and the required standard text for UQ Capacity Building Package. This document must:

- Be a maximum of **2 A4 pages**.
- **Must use the same headings in the same order as D1** (headings may be excluded if no line items are listed in D1).

Please consider the following points when crafting your D3:

- Use this section to address the **Feasibility criterion**; Make sure that D3 details how the items will contribute to the project, and that you have the required facilities for the project.
- Keep your line items in the same order as in the D1 budget (when viewing your application PDF) to enable ease of cross referencing between D1 and D2 for the assessors.
- Noting the year each budget line is requested in (i.e. Year 1, Year 2, etc.) helps reviewers more easily cross reference with D1;
- Use the same headings as in the Description Column in the D1 budget table, e.g. *Personnel, Travel, Field Research, Equipment, Maintenance, Other*.

D3: Details of non-ARC contributions – Cont'd

Personnel:

- Describe what time the candidate will contribute to the project and any other contribution from UQ
- All personnel must be justified under *Personnel*
- Justify what the person will do and how that matches their level (PhD student, HEW level, academic level etc.)
- Note that 30% on-costs have been budgeted in line with the ARC's requirements

Travel and Field Research:

- Justify the need (how will the travel benefit the Future Fellowship project/candidate, what will the outcomes be); and
- Justify the cost (breakdown how you can to your total trip cost).

Equipment:

- Justify why you need the equipment, not just the cost;
- Make clear that the cost is quoted, not just an estimate, including supplier, quote price and make/model of the equipment where practicable.



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2025 ARC Future Fellowships

Application Form

Part E - Classification and other Statistical Information

E2: Types of research activity

This question has been added to ensure compliance to the amended ARC act. See [F3](#).

Select to a total of 100% of how your project aligns with the following research types:

Applied research is original investigation undertaken in order to acquire new knowledge. It is, however, directed primarily towards a specific, practical aim or objective.

Pure basic research is basic research carried out for the advancement of knowledge, without seeking long-term economic or social benefits or making any effort to apply the results to practical problems or to transfer the results to sectors responsible for their application.

Strategic basic research is experimental and theoretical work undertaken to acquire new knowledge directed into specified broad areas in the expectation of practical discoveries. It provides the broad base of knowledge necessary for the solution of recognised practical problems.

E3: Field of Research (FoR-2020)

- Select up to 3 FoR codes at the 6-digit level that relate to the application.
 - Enter FoR codes from highest percentage to lowest percentage into RMS. Note: The highest percentage can only be entered for one FoR code (for example, 50 cannot be entered for 2 FoR codes).
 - Total percentage must total 100.
 - Enter a whole number only. Do not include “%”.
- **FoR codes and their proportions are important in assigning assessors to your application.**
 - The FoR codes and proportions should reflect the nature of the research in this application, particularly if it is interdisciplinary. Assign codes and their proportions as accurately as possible.
 - Avoid assigning “XXXX99” (not elsewhere classified) codes. Only use these as a last resort when there is no other appropriate code is within the classification.

E4: Socio-Economic Objective (SEO-2020)

- Select up to 3 SEO codes at the 6-digit level that indicates the sectors that are most likely to benefit from the project if funded.
 - Enter SEO codes from highest percentage to lowest percentage into RMS. Note: The highest percentage can only be entered for one SEO code (for example, 50 cannot be entered for 2 SEO codes).
 - Total percentage must total 100.
 - Enter a whole number only. Do not include “%”.



THE UNIVERSITY
OF QUEENSLAND
AUSTRALIA

CREATE CHANGE

2025 ARC Future Fellowships

Application Form

Part F - Project Eligibility.

F1: Medical Research – UQ recommendations

- **If there is any potential that parts of your application may be considered medical in nature, you should answer ‘Yes’ to this question.**
- If your research is fundamental, but the next step would be health related/translation, be very careful not to let that bleed into your Fellowship Project proposal. *For example, this often tends to creep into the last aim/objective. In which case the whole application is ruled ineligible due to the last aim.*
- If cell lines are needed, we strongly recommend selecting a non-human cell line. We have received informal advice that use of human cells lines may strongly impact your eligibility ruling.
- ARC Medical Policy: [ARC Medical Research Policy](#)
- Additional information: [ARC Medical Research Policy FAQs](#)
- ARC Medical Research Statement Examples: [ARC Medical Research Policy Eligibility Examples | Australian Research Council](#)

F2: Medical Statements – ARC requirements

- The ARC **will rely solely on the Medical Research Statement to determine whether an application is eligible**. The ARC will not seek further clarification on this statement.
- If applicable, justify why a project complies with the eligible research requirements set out in the ARC Medical Research Policy located on the [ARC website](#). **750-character** limit.
 - A clear statement of the main aim of application, which may include well identified, big picture and long-term intent beyond the scope of the application.
 - Address why areas of research which may appear to be medical are required, for example, to provide proof of concept, demonstrate a platform technology and are many years from medical application.
 - Avoid simply quoting the policy in your response and provide sufficient detail for the ARC to properly understand the intent and limits of the research aims.

F2: Medical Statements – UQ recommendations

Err on the side of caution, and include a F2 statement if there is any minor indication that your research could be deemed medical

It is important to provide sufficient detail for the ARC to properly understand the intent and limits of the research aims, including:

- A clear statement of the aim of your project
- Why the proposed research is eligible (quoting the policy on its own is not sufficient):
 - That your proposed research clearly aligns with one of the eligible research categories
 - and/or does not fall into an ineligible category
- That medical / health goals are not a *direct* outcome of the proposed research
- Why areas of research which may appear medical are needed

F2 Medical Statement - Example 1

The proposed work is focused on the development of new platform technology to probe the neuronal micro circuitry involved with motion control in humans¹ using ultra high-field MRI. Only normal/healthy volunteers will be considered in this study², to gain new fundamental knowledge about the normal functioning human brain². Although improved understanding of inner workings of the human brain can also contribute to advances in healthcare¹, medical applications and medical research are firmly outside of the scope of this project³.

1. Why the research could appear medical or why it needs clarification.
2. Why the research is **eligible** under the [ARC Medical Research Policy](#).
3. Why the research does not fall into the **ineligible** category/Any medical benefits are beyond the scope of this proposal.

**Associate Professor Martijn Cloos, successful Future Fellowship 2020 applicant.*

F2 Medical Statement - Example 2

The focus of this research proposal is the application of quantitative imaging technologies to understand basic developmental biology processes². Although the disruption of these processes may result in congenital malformations¹, translation to future medical applications is well beyond the scope of this proposal.³ The focus is not on attempting to understand or treat neural tube defects³, but to understand more broadly how cells integrate molecular, cellular and mechanical information to form tissue structure and specify their fate.²

1. Why the research could appear medical or why it needs clarification.
2. Why the research is **eligible** under the [ARC Medical Research Policy](#).
3. Why the research does not fall into the **ineligible** category/any medical benefits are beyond the scope of this proposal.

**Dr Melanie White, successful Future Fellowship 2020 applicant.*

F2 Medical Statement - Example 3

This is an engineering project that uses health-related data¹ (publicly available ICU data) in order to develop new models of machine learning on multisource multivariate time-series data. De-identified ICU patient data is ideal for this research to provide proof of concept because of its vastness and complexity, and the relationship between changes in a patient's status over time, interventions of medical staff and the patient outcomes. The research does not have health or medical aims³ but instead aims to provide a decision-support system² capable of generating highly accurate and intuitively explainable prediction results for potential applications in multiple areas, including finance, sensor technology, and cyber-security².

1. Why the research could appear medical or why it needs clarification.
2. Why the research is **eligible** under the [ARC Medical Research Policy](#).
3. Why the research does not fall into the **ineligible** category/Any medical benefits are beyond the scope of this proposal.

* Dr Sen Wang – successful DECRA 2020 applicant

F3: Experimental Development

- This question has been added to ensure compliance to the amended ARC Act. The amended ARC Act explicitly states that research activities that could be considered ‘experimental development’ cannot be funded by the ARC.
- Please also see the [ARC Policy Statement on Experimental Development](#)
- The ARC has provided multiple examples of what is considered Experimental Development in the FT26 Instructions to Applicants (Appendix B).
- You must select “No” to this question. If you believe your project may involve Experimental Development, please reach out to the Research Office for advice.



Work with your mentors and seek peer review.

The Research Office wishes you the best of luck!